

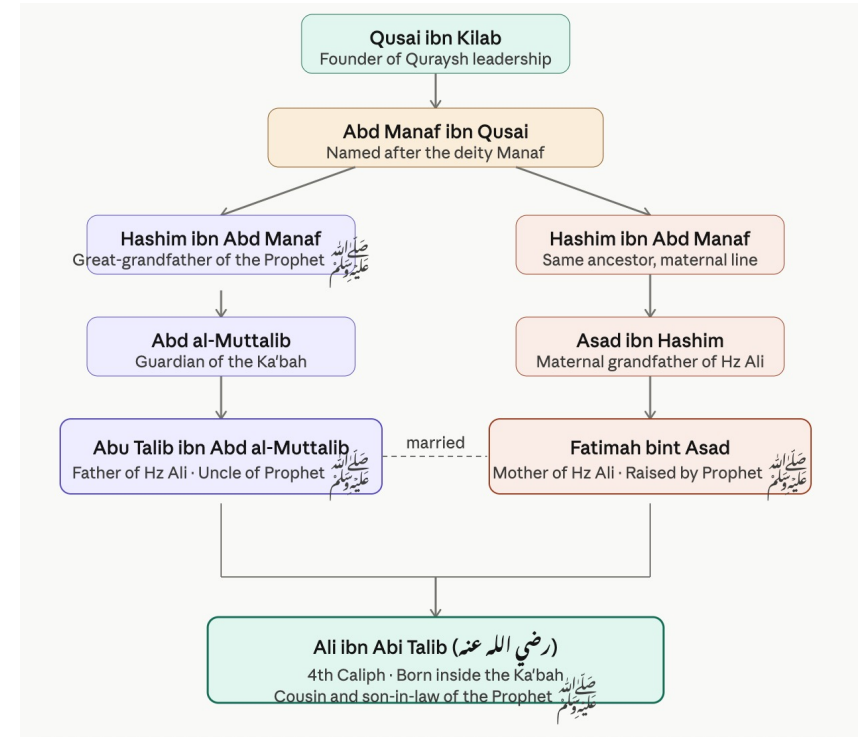
Hz Ali ibn Abi Talib ^{RA}

Who Was Ali ibn Abi Talib?

Life Before the Caliphate

Name and Lineage

- Full name: Ali ibn Abi Talib ibn Abd al-Muttalib ibn Hashim ibn Abd Manaf al-Qurashi al-Hashimi
- His father Abu Talib's real name was Abd Manaf
- His mother was Fatimah bint Asad ibn Hashim, the first Hashimite woman to give birth to a Hashimite child
- She accepted Islam as the second woman after Sayyidah Khadijah ^{RA} and emigrated to Madinah
- Both parents were Banu Hashim, Hz Ali ^{RA} was pure Hashimite on both sides



Other Names of Hz Ali ^{RA}

- When Hz Ali ^{RA} was born, his father Abu Talib was away from Makkah
- His mother named him **Assad**, meaning 'the lion'
- When Abu Talib returned, he changed the name to **Ali**
- Hz Ali RA would reference this himself later in life: 'My mother called me the lion'
- His kunyah was **Abu'l-Hasan**, after his eldest son Hasan
- **Abu Turab**, The Kunyah He Loved Most. One day, Fatimah RA and Hz Ali RA had a disagreement. Hz Ali left the house and was found sleeping against the wall of the masjid, his back covered in dust. The Prophet SAW came to him, wiped the dust from his back, and said: 'Sit up, O Abu Turab (Father of Dust)' Hz Ali RA loved this kunyah more than any other and would use it proudly for the rest of his life

His Early Life, Raised in the Prophet's Household

- Born approximately 10 years before revelation began, roughly 30 years younger than the Prophet ^{SAW}
- His father Abu Talib was very poor and had a large family. The Prophet ^{SAW} took Hz Ali into his home to ease the burden
- Hz Ali RA grew up watching, learning, and following the Prophet ^{SAW} from his earliest years
- He was never tainted by Jahiliyyah and never worshipped idols, owing to his young age at the time of Islam

First to Accept Islam

- Hz Ali ^{RA} embraced Islam at a very young age, opinions range from 7 to 16 years old. The most cited view: around 10
- He was the first boy to accept Islam
- Khadijah RA, first woman
- Zayd ibn al-Harith, first freed slave
- Abu Bakr ^{RA}, first free adult man
- Hz Ali ^{RA} initially kept his Islam secret out of fear of his father, who later ordered him to follow and support the Prophet ^{SAW}

Abu Talib's Four Sons

- **Talib**, the eldest, roughly the Prophet's age. Never accepted Islam. Walked away from the Qurayshi army before Badr. Died without children.
- **Haz Aqil** ^{RA}, expert in Arab genealogy (ansab). Accepted Islam at the Conquest of Makkah. Ransomed from captivity at Badr by his uncle Abbas.
- **Haz Jafar** ^{RA}, the Prophet's beloved cousin, leader of the Hijra to Abyssinia, martyred at the Battle of Mu'tah.
- **Haz Ali** ^{RA}, the youngest. The greatest.

His Physical Description

- Brown-complexioned, large and beautiful eyes
- Full-bellied, bald, above average height
- A thick beard that filled the space between his shoulders
- Thick hair on his chest and shoulders
- Fleshy upper arms, skinny forearms; fleshy thighs, skinny lower legs
- Always smiling, grey hair did not diminish his looks
- Considered one of the most handsome people of his time

His Marriage to Sayyidah Fatimah ^{RA}

- The Prophet ^{SAW} gave his beloved daughter Fatimah al-Zahra in marriage to Hz Ali ^{RA} in the second year of the Hijra
- Their children:
 1. Hasan,
 2. Husayn,
 3. Zaynab al-Kubra,
 4. Umm Kulthum al-Kubra

His Participation in Battles

- Participated in every battle alongside the Prophet ^{SAW} except Tabuk, when the Prophet left him in charge of Madinah
- At Tabuk the Prophet ^{SAW} said: 'Are you not content to stand to me as Harun stood to Musa, except that there is no prophethood after me?' (Bukhari & Muslim)
- At Uhud: received sixteen wounds
- At Badr: among the first to step forward
- At Hunayn: among those who remained steadfast when others fled

The Battle flag at Khaybar

- The Prophet ^{SAW} said: 'Tomorrow I shall give the flag to a man through whose hands Allah will grant victory. He loves Allah and His Messenger, and Allah and His Messenger love him.'
(Bukhari & Muslim)
- The people spent the night wondering who it would be
- The next morning: 'Where is Ali ibn Abi Talib?' He was brought, suffering from a painful eye ailment
- The Prophet ^{SAW} applied his lu'ab Mubarak on Hz Ali's eyes and supplicated for him. He was cured as if he had never had pain
- He was given the battle flag. Khaybar was conquered at his hands

What the Prophet ^{SAW} Said About Him

- Imam Ahmad ibn Hanbal: 'No companion has been mentioned for more virtues than Hz Ali ^{RA}'
- 'He who considers me his friend must also consider Ali his friend.' (Tirmidhi, al-Hakim)
- 'Whoever harms Ali, harms me.' (Ahmad, Abu Ya'la)
- 'Ali does not part with the Quran, nor does the Quran part with Ali; they will be together until they meet me at the Fountain.' (Tabarani)
- 'To look at Ali is an act of worship.' (Tabarani, al-Hakim, hasan isnad)
- 'You will fight for the sake of the Quran just as I fought for its revelation.' (Ahmad, al-Hakim)

The City of Knowledge, His Scholarship

- 'I am the city of knowledge and Ali is its gate.' (Hasan hadith)
- He narrated 586 ahadith from the Prophet ^{SAW}
- Umar ^{RA} would seek refuge with Allah from every difficult case in which Hz Ali ^{RA} was not present
- Hz Aisha ^{RA}: 'He is the most knowledgeable of those who remain, in the Sunnah'
- Ibn Abbas ^{RA}: 'When a trustworthy person relates a fatwa of Ali, we do not go beyond it'
- Masruq: 'The knowledge of the Companions culminated in Umar, Ali, Ibn Mas'ud, and Abdullah'

Session 2 of 3

The Caliphate Begins

35 AH, From the Pledge to the Battle of the Camel

The Sunni Approach when approaching the civil wars

- We approach these events with one firm premise: all the Sahabah were righteous people who would not intentionally harm the Ummah, their differences were political / Ijtihadi and not theological
- We do not go too much into the details and determining who was right or wrong, since there is nothing to be gained.
- There is a lot of fabrication around these incidents and its difficult to separate facts from fiction
- **Umer bin Abdul Azeez** when asked by scholars about the civil wars famously said : “That was a bloodshed that Allah protected my hands from, should I not protect my tongue from that”
- The example of Sahaba is like pools of water, the way to keep them clean is to not dip our hands in them
- When **Haz Hasan Al Basri** was asked about this fitna he said “That was a war the sahaba witnessed but we were absent and they had knowledge of it and we are ignorant of it so when they agree upon something we follow them and when they disagree we stay silent”
- **Ibn Taymiyya** when asked about this fitna said “It is confirmed from authentic reports that Usman, Ali, Tahla, Zubair and Ayesha are the people of Jannah” and “Abu Musa Al-Ashari, Amr Ibn Al As and Muawiyah are all from the sahaba and they have fazail mentioned in the ahadith”

A Caliphate Inherited in Crisis

- Hz Uthman ibn Affan ^{RA} was martyred in 35 AH, on a Friday before Salat-ul-Jumm'a in Dhil-Hijjah
- The Muslim world was in shock and chaos, the assassins were still free, embedded within the Muslim community itself
- In the afternoon a group of Sahaba went to Hz Ali ^{RA} and requested him to be the khalifa
- Hz Ali ^{RA} turned them down and said: 'allow me to be a helper like I've always been a helper'
- When the people insisted, he said: 'I accept. But it must be done in public'
- All the Companions present pledged in masjid-e-nabwi including Hz Talha ^{RA} and Hz Zubayr ^{RA}
- Notable senior Companions who withheld the pledge: Hz Sa'd ibn Abi Waqqas^{RA}, Hz Abdullah ibn Umar^{RA}, Hz Usamah ibn Zayd^{RA}, Hz Abu Sa'id al-Khudri ^{RA}, and others

Issue of Pledge of Allegiance of Hz Talha ^{RA} and Hz Zubayr ^{RA}

Two opinions

1. They did not consider the pledge of allegiance to be valid since many senior companions in Medina and outside did not give their pledge
2. They pledged out of compulsion or by force and not out of free will so did not consider that allegiance to be valid

His First Khutbah as Caliph

"O people! Allah sent a guiding Book in which He has made good and evil clear, so hold on to what is good and abstain from what is evil. Fulfil the obligations to Allah and He will convey you to Paradise. Allah has made the rights of Muslims bound to devotion and belief in His oneness. A Muslim is one from whose verbal and physical abuse other Muslims are safe, except in matters of truth. The blood of a Muslim is not lawful. Hasten to see to the affairs of the masses and prepare for death. The people have gone ahead of you, and the Final Hour urges you on from behind."

Hz Ali ibn Abi Talib ^{RA}, First khutbah as Caliph, 35 AH

Two Urgent Crises

- **Crisis 1:** Punishing the Assassins of Uthman ^{RA}: The killers were still free and embedded among Hz Ali's own supporters. Hz Ali ^{RA} sought to consolidate authority first, then act, a position many Companions found too slow
- **Crisis 2:** The Governors: All of Uthman's governors were sources of complaint. Hz Ali ^{RA} replaced them all at once
- **New appointments:** Hz Uthman ibn Hunayf ^{RA}(Basra), Hz Umarah ibn Shihab ^{RA}(Kufa, turned back), Hz Ubaydullah ibn Abbas ^{RA}(Yemen), Hz Qays ibn Sa'd ^{RA}(Egypt), Hz Sahl ibn Hunayf^{RA}(Levant, turned back by Muawiyah's forces)

Most historians agree it was politically not the best decision to dismiss all governors at once. The wisest Companions, including Hz Mughirah ibn Shu'bah ^{RA} and Hz Ibn Abbas^{RA}, advised him to wait until he had consolidated control. Hz Ali ^{RA} refused, he believed pretending to keep men he disapproved of was a violation of his honesty

Hz Muawiyah's ^{RA} Refusal

- Hz Muawiyah ibn Abi Sufyan ^{RA}, governor of Syria, refused to pledge allegiance
- His position: the killers of Uthman must be punished first, before a pledge could be given
- He sent a letter addressed only 'From Muawiyah to Ali ibn Abi Talib', deliberately omitting Hz Ali's title as Commander of the Faithful
- Scholars and leaders of Syria backed Muawiyah, all demanding qisas for Uthman ^{RA}
- Ibn Hazm in Al-Milal wan Nihal: Muawiyah never doubted Hz Ali's virtue or his right to the caliphate. His demand was specifically for qisas to precede the bay'ah

The demand for Revenge

- Within a week of Hz Usman's shahadat Hz Talhah^{RA} and Hz Zubayr^{RA} visited hazrat Ali^{RA} and said that it is now time to deal with the murder of Hz Usman^{RA}

"We demand that vengeance be taken on the assassins. Those men took the liberty of shedding that man's blood."

"Fellow brothers," 'Ali answered, "I am well-aware of that. But how do I handle people who have control over us, whereas we have none over them? You saw how your servants revolted with them and your Bedouins declared loyalty to them. They can do with us whatever they please. Do you think we are in a position to do that which you ask for?" "No," they returned. 'Ali then rejoined, "I swear by Allah, I will not do but that which you agree to. Let us wait till people calm down, the fury in their hearts abates, and each retrieves his right. So leave me now, and see which way things will go then come back to me."

Hz Zubayr RA and Hz Talha RA go on Umrah to Makkah

- 4 months went by without any action from Hz Ali ^{RA}.
- At this point Hz Talha and Hz Zubair leave Medina to perform Umrah in Makkah
- Hz Ayesha and other umhat-ul-mu'mineen are already in Makkah
- It is discussed among them that this in-activity is not acceptable
- Hz Ayesha ^{RA}, Hz Talha ^{RA} and Hz Zubayr ^{RA} decide to leave for Basra to get the support of some senior sahaba and military leaders who were there for this cause. There was never any intent to fight with Hz Ali ^{RA} in the minds of any of the three.

The battle of the Camel

Jang-e-Jamal

March to Basra

- Hz Ayesha was on her camel in a howdaj.
- According to At-tabbari, they left Makkah with 500-600 people and by the time they reached basra they were 30,000 strong.
- The governor of Basra Ibne Hunayf was loyal to Hz Ali ^{RA} and on seeing this huge number of people he panicked and sent out a group of people to investigate the purpose Hz Ayesha's was coming to Basra for.
- Things ended up getting tense between them and there were some skirmishes and some lives were lost.
- The governor of Basa sent a message to Hz Ali ^{RA} to come and deal with this situation.

Negotiations with Hz Ali ^{RA}

- Hz Ali ^{RA} came to Basra and when he was one day away from the city he camped. Sent his emissary named Hz. Qa'qa' ibn Amr to ask Hz Ayesha ^{RA} of her purpose there.
- Hz Ayesha said that they had come to avenge the murder of Hz Uthman ^{RA} and to bring about reconciliation between Hz Ali and Hz Mu'awiyah.
- For 3 days Qa'qa' goes back and forth between the two parties to negotiate and finally a compromise is reached
- It is to expel the protesting mobs from Medina, take away the ranks of people around Hz Ali ^{RA} who sympathized with the mobs and start investigation into the murder.
- Ibn-e- Kathir writes that that night both the camps went back completely satisfied with the outcome.
- But the killers of Hz Uthman ^{RA} did not want there to be peace

The Day of the Battle

- 2,000 people from the mobs split into two groups of 1,000 men each. They launched a surprise attack in the middle of the night on both the camps of Hz Ayesha ^{RA} and Hz Ali ^{RA} and claimed they they're from the other side. Both the sides considered this a huge betrayal.
- The battle lasted most of that day and countless people lost their lives. (Al-Tabari estimates there to be around 10,000 people)
- Hz Talha ^{RA} was shouting to the soldiers to sheath their swords as he felt something was wrong when an arrow hit him on the leg and caused him to die of bleeding
- There are some narrations (hassan according to some and dhaif according to others) which mention that Hz Ali ^{RA} sent a message to Hz Zubayr ^{RA} reminding him of a hadith of the prophet ^{SAW} which had predicted that Ali and Zubayr will fight and Zubayr will be on the wrong. Hz Zubair ^{RA} had forgotten about this hadith and upon being reminded he left the battle scene. Other narrations mention he left the battle field because he just could not be a part of what was happening.
- On that night when Hz Zubayr ^{RA} was offering Tahajjud, one of the people from the mob killed him during his salah.

Hz Ali's ^{RA} Treatment of Hz Aisha ^{RA}

- After the battle, Hz Ali ^{RA} went personally to Hz Aisha ^{RA} and asked: 'How are you, O Mother?'
- She replied: 'I am well. May Allah forgive you.' He said: 'And you as well'
- He ordered she be moved to the house of Khalaf ibn Abdillah with full honour
- He sent forty reputable women of Basra to accompany her and her brother Muhammad ibn Abi Bakr on the journey to Makkah
- He bid her farewell on the day of her departure
- Aisha ^{RA} later said: 'By Allah, there was nothing between Hz Ali and I except what normally takes place between a woman and her in-laws. Despite this misunderstanding with me, he is among the best of people'

Hz Aisha's^{RA} Regret, Her Own Words

- Whenever Aisha^{RA} remembered the Battle of the Camel, she would weep until her garment became wet with tears
- She regretted going, because it unintentionally led to what it led to. It was never her intention to cause bloodshed
- The Sunni position is unequivocal: to accuse Aisha RA of bad intention is to cast doubt on one's own iman
- She is the Mother of the Believers, the wife of the Prophet ^{SAW} in this world and the Hereafter
- Hz Ali ^{RA} himself said: 'She is most certainly the wife of your Prophet in this world and in the Hereafter'

After the Battle, Consolidation

- Hz Ali RA announced to the people of Basra: Do not pursue the fleeing. Do not attack the injured. Do not enter any house. Do not take possessions
- He performed the funeral prayer over all the dead from both sides, Basran and Kufan alike
- He moved the capital from Madinah to Kufa, closer to Syria where the greater challenge lay
- He appointed Hz Abdullah ibn Abbas^{RA} as governor of Basra, with Ziyad ibn Abi Sufyan as assistant for the kharaj
- He appointed Qays ibn Hz Sa'd ibn Ubadah^{RA}, one of the wisest of men, as governor of Egypt
- The people of Basra pledged allegiance to him

Siffin, the Khawarij, and the Martyrdom

The Road to Siffin

- After the Battle of the Camel, Hz Ali RA sent Hz Jarir ibn Abdullah al-Bajali ^{RA} to Muawiyah asking for the pledge of allegiance
- Muawiyah refused, demanding punishment of Uthman's assassins first
- Scholars and leaders of Syria backed him, all demanding qisas
- Hz Ali ^{RA} sent multiple delegations. All attempts at reconciliation failed
- By Shawwal 36 AH, Hz Ali ^{RA} had no choice but to mobilise his army and march toward Syria

The Battle of Siffin, 37 AH

- Hz Ali ^{RA} led approximately 90,000. Muawiyah led approximately 85,000
- They met on the plains of Siffin near the Euphrates River, east of Halab
- For one month, envoys went back and forth. All peace attempts failed
- Full-scale war began on Safar 1st, 37 AH
- Six days of fierce fighting, neither side prevailed
- On the seventh day, fighting grew more intense than any previous day
- Total casualties by the battle's end: approximately 70,000 Muslims, including hundreds of Companions and many reciters of the Quran

The Death of Hz Ammar ibn Yasir ^{RA}, A Prophecy Fulfilled

- During the fiercest fighting, Hz Ammar ibn Yasir ^{RA}, the great and beloved Companion, was killed by Muawiyah's forces
- The Companions on Hz Ali's side immediately recalled the Prophetic hadith: 'The transgressing party will kill Ammar.' (Bukhari & Muslim)
- This roused Hz Ali's army with certainty that they were upon the truth
- Those who knew the hadith on Muawiyah's side immediately stopped fighting
- Hz Muawiyah ^{RA} said: 'We didn't kill him. Ali killed him by bringing him here.'
- Hz Ali's side was now on the verge of complete victory

The Qurans on the Spears

- When Muawiyah realised defeat was near, Hz Amr ibn al-As ^{RA} devised a plan: raise copies of the Quran on spear-tips and call for arbitration by the Book of Allah
- When Hz Ali's soldiers saw the Qurans raised, a large group immediately demanded: 'Resort to Allah's Book, Ali!'
- Hz Ali ^{RA} tried to explain: this is deception, we are on the verge of victory, true judgment will come through our swords
- His soldiers refused to listen. They threatened to hand him over to Muawiyah if he continued fighting
- Hz Ali ^{RA} was forced to accept arbitration against his own judgement

The Arbitration, Ramadan 37 AH

- The agreement was signed on Wednesday, 17 Safar 37 AH. The arbitration was set for Dumat al-Jandal in Ramadan
- Hz Ali's representative: Hz Abu Musa al-Ash'ari ^{RA}, chosen under pressure (Hz Ali had wanted Hz Abdullah ibn Abbas)
- Muawiyah's representative: Amr ibn al-As
- The arbitrators pledged to decide on the basis of the Quran and the Sunnah
- When the agreement was written, the title 'Commander of the Faithful' was disputed. Hz Ali ^{RA}, following the example of Hudaybiyyah, erased his title rather than cause further conflict

The Arbitration Outcome, A Political Trap

- At Dumat al-Jandal, Amr ibn al-As deceived Abu Musa into speaking first
- Abu Musa announced publicly: 'We have agreed to depose both Ali and Muawiyah and leave the Muslims to choose their caliph'
- He stepped down. Amr then said: 'I endorse my friend Muawiyah, as Uthman's companion and heir'
- Abu Musa was shocked. The gathering broke up in anger
- Result: Syria rallied further to Muawiyah and pledged him allegiance as caliph. Hz Ali's supporters became more committed to him, but the Ummah was now more divided than ever

The Birth of the Khawarij

- After the arbitration, a group within Hz Ali's army refused to accept the outcome and declared: 'La hukma illa lillah, There is no judgement but that of Allah!'
- They accused Hz Ali ^{RA} of departing from the Quran by accepting human arbitration
- When Hz Ali refused to denounce himself and accept their demands, 6,000 men broke away and camped at a plain called Harura near Kufa
- Not a single Companion of the Prophet ^{SAW} was among them, only young zealous men with outward piety
- The Prophet ^{SAW} had predicted their coming in over 10 ahadith

What the Prophet ^{SAW} Predicted About Them

- 'There will emerge people from my nation who will read the Quran but it will not pass their throats'
- 'Their faith will be in their mouths only, not in their hearts'
- 'You will think your prayer is nothing compared to theirs, your fasting nothing compared to theirs, but they will leave the fold of Islam like an arrow leaves its prey and never return'
- 'They will leave the people of idols alone and kill the worshippers of Allah'
- 'Those who fight them have a better claim to obeying Allah than they do'
- Source: Bukhari, Muslim, Ahmad, over 10 ahadith on this topic

Ibn Abbas Debates the Khawarij at Harura

- Hz Ali ^{RA} sent Abdullah ibn Abbas to negotiate. Ibn Abbas dressed in his finest clothes and wore perfume, choosing the post-Zohar time deliberately when people would be calm
- He entered to find 6,000 men buzzing with Quran recitation even during rest time. All had marks of prostration on their foreheads, shaved heads, rough wool clothes
- They asked: 'Why do you dress like this?' Ibn Abbas replied: 'I saw the Prophet ^{SAW} wear something better. Allah says: Who has forbidden the fine garments that Allah has created for His servants and the pure good food....?'
- There were thousands of sahaba alive at that time and not even one sahabi was in those 6,000 Khawarij, Ibne Abbas RA pointed this out and said I'm coming from the group of Sahaba and the cousin and son in law of the Prophet SAW.
- Hz Ibne Abbas asked them what their problem was with Hz Ali RA, they said three things

Three objections of Khawarij

1. Ali opted for Arbitration of men (Amr and Abu Musa) and ignored the book of Allah SWT
 2. He fought the battle of Jamal and Siffeen and he neither took Ghanimah nor captives of war. If the people he fought were non-muslims then why didn't he take Ghanimah and if he fought muslims then how could he fight them
 3. When the treaty was written down Ali RA did not write Ameer-ul-Mu'mineen. If he's not Ameer-ul-mu'mineen then he's ameer-ul-kafireen
- Ibne Abbas RA said if I debated you and gave rebuttal of your objections then will you return to our camp. They said yes. He gave rebuttals

Three rebuttals to Khawarij

1. Don't you know that Allah in Quran has asked us to do arbitration in trivial matters like hunting in the state of Ihram to determine Kuffara. What is more important, arbitration for the cost of a rabbit or arbitration for the blood of muslims. Also the arbitration before divorce.
2. Who amongst you will be willing to take their mother Ayesha RA as their captive and who amongst you would dare to treat her like a captive. If anyone of you dares to do that then you are a Kafir as Quran clearly mentions that Prophet SAW wives are our mothers.

Quran says if two groups are fighting then bring peace and reconciliation between them... Allah called both the groups believers although they're fighting with one another

3. Don't you know that on the day of Hudaibia, the prophet SAW gave up his own title and did not write RasulAllah on the treaty. If the prophet SAW can do it for his muqam then surely Ali can do it for his muqam.

The Killing of Hz Abdullah Ibne Aratt

1. On hearing the rebuttals, 2,000 of the Khawarij returned to the camp of Hz Ali RA.
2. 4,000 remained even after hearing the rebuttals, so this group had no sincerity at all.
3. Some of them even interacted with Hz Ali RA in Kufa during a bayan and demanded that he repent, re-accept Islam and fight Hz Mu'awiya RA.
4. Hz Ali RA tried to give them concessions.
5. They elected their own Ameer, Abdullah ibn Wahb al-Rasibi
6. They then started to invite other fanatics to their camp by writing letters to other cities. More people started joining them as their slogans were captivating
7. They started highway robbery
8. One one of the highway robbery they slaughtered a sahabi, Abdullah Ibne Khabbab Ibne Aratt RA, son of a major Sahabi Khabbab Ibne Artt , one of the earliest converts to Islam.
9. After this barbaric incident people became afraid of this group and the news reached Hz Ali RA who knew an action had to be taken.

The Battle of Nahrawan, 38 AH

- Hz Ali ^{RA} demanded they hand over the killers. They replied: 'We all did it'
- Hz Ali RA himself lead the army to batter with these people in Nahrwan.
- In face of the army, most people left the Khawarij group and a few remained
- Before the battle, Hz Ali told his men: 'Among them is a man with a short hand like the nipple of a breast, with seven strands of hair on it. Search for him in the dead.' The Prophet ^{SAW} had predicted this sign
- The Khawarij were nearly annihilated: approximately 2,800 killed. Only 5-8 survived
- Hz Ali's losses: 9 men. The short-armed man was found exactly as described
- Hz Ali RA said: 'Allah and His Messenger have spoken the truth'

The Final Phase, A Caliph Abandoned

- After Nahrawan, Hz Ali's soldiers were exhausted and refused to march to Syria again
- Muawiyah seized provinces one by one: Egypt fell to Amr ibn al-As. Hijaz and Yemen came under his control
- Only Iraq and Persia remained loyal to Hz Ali ^{RA}
- In 40 AH, Hz Muawiyah RA proposed peace: Ali keeps Iraq, Muawiyah keeps Syria, neither attacks the other
- Hz Ali ^{RA} accepted. A fragile peace was established

The Conspiracy, Three Khawarij, One Night

- Three Khawarij met and made a solemn pact on the night of Ramadan 17th, 40 AH:
- Abd al-Rahman ibn Muljam: 'I will kill Ali ibn Abi Talib'
- Al-Burak ibn Abdullah: 'I will kill Muawiyah ibn Abi Sufyan'
- Amr ibn Bakr al-Tamimi: 'I will kill Amr ibn al-As'
- Al-Burak struck Muawiyah but only wounded him in the buttock
- Amr ibn Bakr killed Kharijah ibn Hudhafah, who was leading Fajr prayer in place of Amr ibn al-As
- Ibn Muljam went to Kufa

The Martyrdom, Friday, 17 Ramadan, 40 AH

- As Hz Ali ^{RA} called the people to Fajr prayer at the mosque of Kufa, Ibn Muljam stepped forward and struck him on the forehead with a poisoned sword, reaching the brain
- Hz Ali ^{RA} said: 'Do not let this man escape.' The people seized Ibn Muljam
- Ali ^{RA} said: 'A life for a life. If I die, kill him as he killed me. Do not mutilate him, I heard the Messenger of Allah say: Do not mutilate anything, even a wounded dog'
- He lingered through Friday and Saturday and died on the night before Sunday
- He was approximately 63 years old
- His sons Hz Hasan RA, Hz Husayn RA, and his nephew Abdullah ibn Jafar washed his body.
- He was buried in Kufa

His Final Advice to His Sons

- 'Fear Allah and do not pursue this world even if it comes toward you'
- 'Speak the truth. Show mercy to orphans. Help those who are lost'
- 'Oppose the oppressor. Help the oppressed. Act upon what is in the Book of Allah'
- 'Establish the prayer at its appointed time. Give the zakat in the appropriate place'
- 'Forgive sins committed against you. Subdue your anger. Maintain ties of kinship'
- 'Be forbearing towards the ignorant. Gain a deep understanding of the religion'
- 'Remain attached to the Quran. Enjoin good and forbid evil'

After Hz Ali ^{RA}, The Year of Union

- The people of Kufa pledged allegiance to Hasan ibn Ali RA as caliph
- Hasan ^{RA} recognised that the Iraqi forces were unreliable and that further bloodshed would serve no one
- In Rabee al-Awal, 41 AH, Hasan RA handed the caliphate to Muawiyah on agreed conditions
- This year became known as Aam al-Jama'ah, the Year of Union, as all Muslims united under one leader
- The Prophet ^{SAW} had said: 'This son of mine is a sayyid, and perhaps Allah will bring about peace between two great groups of Muslims through him'
- No sooner did Muslims reunite under Muawiyah than the great Islamic conquests resumed